BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #3 · CHRONIC ILLNESS

“I will never feel well again.”

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Where it often comes from

Long illness wears down hope. After many treatments, setbacks, and bad days, the mind starts to treat the present as permanent. Even good days feel like a pause before the next crash.

What Scripture teaches

“Therefore we do not lose heart.” Scripture says, “He gives power to the faint and increases the strength of the weak… those who wait upon the LORD will renew their strength.” “Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning” (Psalm 30:5). We cannot promise a medical outcome, but we can say that the future is not yours to see and that God holds it. Better and worse days are still ahead, and God is with you in each.

> *“He gives power to the faint and increases the strength of the weak. Even youths grow tired and weary, and young men stumble and fall. But those who wait upon the LORD will renew their strength; they will mount up with wings like eagles; they will run and not grow weary, they will walk and not faint”* (Isaiah 40:29–31).

Also see

> “Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day” (2 Corinthians 4:16).

> “For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning” (Psalm 30:5).

> “Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!” (Lamentations 3:22–23).

> “I consider that our present sufferings are not comparable to the glory that will be revealed in us” (Romans 8:18).

Common self-statements

- This will never end.
- I will always feel this way.
- There is no hope for recovery.
- Good days are a trick.
- What is the point of trying?
- I have already tried everything.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I will either be fully well or never improve.
- Fortune telling: Predicting a permanent future.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling terrible and concluding that I always will.
- Labeling: Calling myself hopeless.

Challenging questions

- What has actually changed over time, even a little?
- What good days have I had, and what made them better?
- What do my doctors honestly say about the outlook?
- What does hope mean if the outcome is uncertain?
- What does Scripture promise about God's presence and renewal?
- What is one thing that helps today?

Truth summary

> I cannot see the future, and neither can my feelings. God gives strength to the weak, and I can hope in Him one day at a time, whatever my health brings.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Sickness
- Suffering
- Faith
- Tired

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I will never feel well again"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I will never feel well again." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What has actually changed over time, even a little?
- ☐ What good days have I had, and what made them better?
- ☐ What do my doctors honestly say about the outlook?
- ☐ What does hope mean if the outcome is uncertain?
- ☐ What does Scripture promise about God's presence and renewal?
- ☐ What is one thing that helps today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God gives power to the faint.
- ☐ Those who wait on Him renew strength.
- ☐ Weeping may last the night; joy comes.
- ☐ His mercies are new every morning.
- ☐ I do not lose heart.
- ☐ Today is enough to face.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Isaiah 40:29–31
  "He gives power to the faint and increases the strength of the weak. Even youths grow tired and weary, and young men stumble and fall. But those who wait upon the LORD will renew their strength; they will mount up with wings like eagles; they will run and not grow weary, they will walk and not faint."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:16
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day."
- ☐ Psalm 30:5
  "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Today's strength: Each day, note one thing that went better than expected.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Isaiah 40:29–31 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God gives power to the faint and renews my strength.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Track good moments. Write down better hours or days.
- ☐ Ask your doctor. Discuss realistic goals and what helps.
- ☐ Plan small joys. Schedule something gentle each day.
- ☐ Read Lamentations 3:22–23. Receive fresh mercy each morning.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I will never feel well again": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Today's strength
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I will never feel well again.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am weary of being unwell. Give strength to the faint, renew me day by day, and keep hope alive in me whatever comes. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.